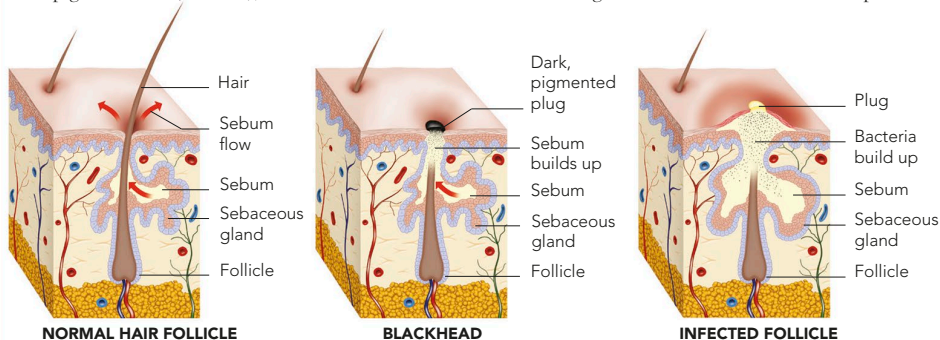


ACNE

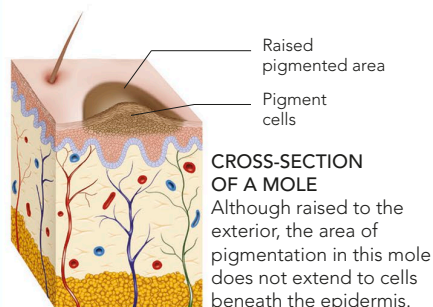
In acne vulgaris, the sebaceous glands produce an excessive amount of the oily-waxy secretion, sebum. This reacts in contact with air and forms a plug in the skin pore, which may appear dark with pigmentation (not dirt), as a blackhead or

comedone, or pale, as a whitehead. A combination of trapped sebum, dead skin cells, and bacterial infection inflame the area, and a pustule develops. Acne is a common problem at puberty, when hormone surges cause increased sebum output.



MOLE

A mole, or naevus, is a localized overproduction and aggregation of the skin's pigment cells (melanocytes), with increased amounts of melanin pigment. Moles are very common – most adults have 10–20 moles by the age of 30 years. They can occur almost anywhere on the body and are variable in size, but usually less than 1cm ($\frac{3}{8}$ in) across. Rarely, moles become malignant (cancerous); any change in size or appearance, itching, or bleeding should be discussed with a doctor.



CYST

The most common type of cyst is a sebaceous cyst that forms in a hair follicle. A cyst contains sebaceous secretions and dead cells, which are restrained in a strong, bag-like capsule. Its surface mound is usually smooth, and some cysts have a paler or darker central region. Common sites include the scalp, face, trunk, and genitals, although they can occur just about anywhere. Treatment may be needed if the cyst becomes enlarged, unsightly, painful, or infected.

